

Hackles Club, Track B: Hands-On Hackers (Ages 8-11)

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The six strands, hand-linked, in the order the lessons take them.

A free kit by **Competence Collective** · competencecollective.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]



OCTOBER 2026

CONTENTS

Contents

1. At a glance 4

2. Supply list: under \$10 for the whole Club 6

3. Session 1: The Help Ladder 7

4. Session 2: Passphrase Lab 10

5. Session 3: Scam Spotters 13

6. Session 4: Data Detective 16

7. Session 5: Kind Clicks and Upstander Moves 18

8. Session 6: Oops Recovery, Family Code Word and a Quick Door (the Club finale) 21

9. Camp Session 7: The Quiet Door Escape (camp only) 24

10. Camp Session 8: Hackles Day, Kids Run the Stations (camp only) 25

11. Quick reference for leaders 26

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

[Logo: Hackles]

A 6-session club, an 8-session summer-camp version, and a 30-minute library story time

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org

Status: DRAFT. [VERIFY] and [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] flags must be cleared before publication. Read 00_Start_Here_Club_Leaders.md first, especially Sections 5, 6 and 7.

No child accounts, no child data collected, ever.

01 At a glance

SPECIMEN LABEL	
AGES	8 to 11 (grades 3 to 6)
GROUP	6 to 25 kids, two adults, teams of 3 to 5
SESSION LENGTH	45 to 60 minutes (club). 30 minutes (story time)
READING NEEDED	Light. Teams read short cards. Any child may pass the card to a teammate.
DEVICES	None
CARDS	Set B in 01_Club_Card_Sets.md
CREW	Hackle, Latch, Peeper, Pip, Buddy, Ember, Fixit, Rinse, Gifty (adult voice only)

THE SIX-SESSION CLUB AND THE EIGHT-SESSION CAMP

#	TITLE	MAIN GAME	CLUB	CAMP
1	The Help Ladder	Ladder Climb and Mini Trail	yes	yes
2	Passphrase Lab	Passphrase Vault mission	yes	yes
3	Scam Spotters	Spot the Fishy: Pond Patrol	yes	yes
4	Data Detective	Mosaic game and Share or Shell	yes	yes
5	Kind Clicks and Upstander Moves	Four Moves corners	yes	yes
6	Oops Recovery, Family Code Word and a Quick Door	Role-plays plus Quick Door	yes (finale)	yes
7	The Quiet Door Escape	Full mission, 4 stages	no	yes
8	Hackles Day: Kids Run the Stations	Stations for families	no	yes

STANDARD SESSION SHAPE

MIN	PART
5	Gather. Two promises. Hackles Chant (the 3-5 version: "Hackles up! Pause! Check! Tell!" with hand signals).
5	Warm-up game.
15 to 20	Main game.
8 to 10	Talk and practice. Tell sentence or role-play.
4	Calm-down or screen-break moment.
5	Close. Take-home card. Tell Wave.

WORDS TO KEEP ON THE WALL

- **Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.** (Hand signals: neck brush, Pause Palm, magnifier circles, Tell Wave.)
- **SPOT:** Secrets, Pressure, Offers too good to be true, Tricks to move you (a link or a login ask).
- **Help Ladder:** a friend you trust, then a trusted adult, then a report tool.
Next-Rung Rule: if the first person does not help, you are not done. Tell the next person.
- **Long. Silly. Secret.** (Passphrases.)

02 **Supply list: under \$10 for the whole Club**

Prices are rough [VERIFY locally]. Assume you already own paper, pencils, crayons, a timer and a printer.

ITEM	USE	ESTIMATE
Pack of 100 index cards	Scenes, word cards, passports	\$2
Two dice	Search-space demo	\$1
Small envelopes (a pack) or recycled paper folded into envelopes	Mission envelopes, envelope demo	\$2
Roll of masking tape	Trail, Door line	\$3
Pom-poms or beans	Pond jar	\$1
Total		About \$9

Free extras: a cardboard box for Gifty, a ribbon, sticky notes, scrap paper.

03 **Session 1: The Help Ladder**

Goal: Kids can name their rungs (a friend you trust, a trusted adult, a report tool), and know to keep climbing if the first person does not help.

Crew: Hackle, Buddy.

Supplies: Masking tape for a 15-space trail, Set B Trail scenes (TB1 to TB10), a Crew Token, 8 pom-poms, a box for Gifty.

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
5	Warm-up: Ladder Climb
20	Main game: Mini Trail (3 zones, 15 spaces)
10	Talk and practice: Rung Two Says "Ignore It"
4	Calm-down
5	Close

LEADER SCRIPT

Gather. SAY: "Welcome to Hackles Club. Hackles are what rise on the back of your neck when something feels off. We practice four moves: Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell. Two promises: a false alarm is fine, and it is never your fault."

Warm-up: Ladder Climb. Everyone stands and climbs an invisible ladder, hand over hand. SAY: "Rung 1: a friend you trust. Rung 2: a trusted adult. Rung 3: a report tool, with an adult. I will read a scenario. You climb one rung at a time and say the sentence out loud."

- Rung 1: "Will you come with me while I tell someone?"
- Rung 2: "I need help with something online. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."
- Rung 3: "I'm using the report button, and I'd like an adult to help."

Then the second leader plays the friend at Rung 1 and says, "Ignore it. It is nothing." The group shouts: "**Next rung!**" and climbs. At the top everyone does the Tell Wave: "I told someone!"

Keep the "does not help" role kind: "I'm busy, later," never mean.

Main game: Mini Trail. Tape 15 spaces in three zones: Fishy Pond (spaces 1 to 5), Share Meadow (6 to 10), Fix-It Bridge (11 to 15). Teams are one crew that walks together. SAY: "Gifty the Too-Good Box tries to trip us up. We answer scenes together. If we answer well, we climb five steps. Okay, four.

If we pick the oops-path, three steps and Fixit says something kind. Nobody loses."

Read a scene from Set B (TB1 to TB10). Teams whisper-think for 10 seconds. On "Peek!" teams show a hand signal or a held-up A, B or C card. Read the best answer. The Crew Token moves. After every second scene, Gifty (adult voice) pops up with a silly offer. The class says, "No thanks, Gifty!"

Use 6 scenes, 3 Gifty turns and 1 Ladder scene (TB1 or TB6). Finish with the Big Pause: one slow breath, everyone says, "Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell."

Talk and practice: Rung Two Says "Ignore It" (adapted from Role-play R3). Triads: Teller, Friend, Trusted Adult. Message card: "A message asked for your game password. You tell your friend. The friend says, 'It is probably nothing.'"

- **Teller:** "Thanks. I think I should tell a grown-up anyway. Will you come with me?"
- **Teller (to the adult):** "I need help with something online. A message asked for my password. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."
- **Trusted Adult:** "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."

Swap roles. Then ask: "What was hard? What would you say?"

Calm-down. Ember's Warm Breath.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Hackles Club: The Help Ladder. Today your child practiced telling a trusted adult, and what to do if the first person does not help. Try at home (5 minutes): Ask your child: "Who are three people you could tell?" Add yourself. Then say the Good Grown-up Reply together: "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child names nobody as a trusted adult.** Do not press. Say, "Today, your Club leaders count." Tell your safeguarding lead gently the same day.
- **A child says they told someone and nothing happened.** Say, "Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing. When the first person does not help, we climb to the next rung. I am a next rung." Then use the Start Here card.
- **The Trail runs long.** Stop at 8 spaces. Skip Gifty's third turn.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES, BEST FOR AGES 8 TO 9)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
10	Reader's theater of Role-play R3 with a puppet and the librarian (Games Pack, file 06)
5	Ladder Climb
8	Three Trail scenes on a table-top trail
2	Warm Breath
2	Take-home card

Camp stretch (+15 minutes): Teams write a Tell sentence on a sticky note and trade it with another team.

04 Session 2: Passphrase Lab

Goal: Kids can tell a strong passphrase (long, random words, not about you) from a weak password, and refuse to share one.

Crew: Latch.

Supplies: Two dice, Stage 1 password cards, Word Bank cards (24), a cipher strip, envelopes, a sheet of paper for the vault checklist.

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
5	Warm-up: How big is the guess? (dice)
20	Main game: The Passphrase Vault (Mission E1, Stages 1, 3 and 4)
10	Passphrase Rap and "No thanks" practice
4	Calm-down
5	Close

LEADER SCRIPT

Warm-up: How big is the guess? (Concepts Lab Demo 01, "Try This Now").

Hide one die under a cup. A volunteer guesses (up to 6 tries). Hide two dice: how many tries now? (Up to 36.) Ask: "What happens with ten dice?" SAY: "That growing number is called a search space. A password is a lock. The more guesses a thief needs, the stronger the lock."

Main game: The Passphrase Vault (from Mission E1, Games Pack file 03).

SAY: "Mateo's abuela locked her family photo album with a passphrase. Her note got scrambled. The Quiet Door will only open if we solve the puzzles. Latch the padlock is nervous. Latch says: a good passphrase is long, silly and secret."

- **Stage 1, Strength Sorter.** Six cards: P1 Mateo2014. P2 purple-pancake-rocket-giraffe. P3 password. P4 12345678. P5 Sunnyday!. P6 stapler-moon-jelly-bicycle. Latch's rule: strong means long, made of random words and not about you. Which two cards are strong? (P2 and P6. Envelope "26".)
- **Stage 2, Mateo's Cipher** (optional, 60-minute sessions). Shift-by-1 cipher: OFWFS TIBSF JU. Move each letter back one step. (NEVER SHARE IT.)
- **Stage 3, Build a Passphrase.** The team picks four words from a Word Bank of 24 cards (stapler, moon, jelly, bicycle, pancake, rocket, giraffe, purple, window, noodle, trumpet, cactus, pillow, lantern, penguin, marble, spaghetti, turnip, zipper, sailboat, pickle, meteor, cupcake, umbrella). Checklist: 4 or more words, no names, birthdays or pets, not a

song or a quote. **Say first: "These are practice words, never a real passphrase."**

- **Stage 4, Level-Up Offer.** A friend says in game chat: "Give me your game password so I can level you up! I'll give it back." Choose: A) give it, B) "Nope. If you want to team up, let's play together. My password is only for me and my grown-up," C) change it every day. (B.)

Door Phrase: "LONG. SILLY. SECRET."

Rap (3 minutes). Stomp-clap beat (STOMP, CLAP, STOMP, CLAP):

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
Short little password? That's a flop! A thief can guess it before you stop. Four weird words, now watch me go: Pickle! Giraffe! Trombone! Yo-yo! Chorus: Long! Silly! Secret! Strong! A thief would guess it all night long!	

(The Rap is from the Games Pack, file 05. A phrase the whole class has heard is no longer secret. Never use a real passphrase.)

Talk. Why not use your birthday? Who helps you keep passphrases safe (a trusted adult, or a password manager your family chose)?

Calm-down. Warm Breath.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 3
Hackles Club: Passphrase Lab. Today we learned: long, silly, secret. A long string of random words is harder to guess than a short, tricky password. Try at home: Make a four-word silly phrase together as a game. Do not use it for a real account. Talk about who in your family should know real passwords.	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child says their real passphrase aloud.** Say, "That one sounds real. Let's change it with your grown-up tonight. Try a silly one for the game." Do not repeat it. Tell the family at pickup in one calm sentence.
- **The cipher frustrates a team.** Give hint 1: "Say the alphabet in your head. If the code says O, the letter before O is N."
- **A child says "my dad uses the same password everywhere".** "Thank you for telling me. It is a good thing to talk about at home. We have a take-home card." Do not criticise the family.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
12	Read-Aloud 6: "Mateo's Passphrase Puzzle" (Games Pack, file 04)
5	Talk and "Try it" (pick four words from a pile, say them to a neighbor)
5	Stage 1 Strength Sorter
3	Warm Breath
2	Take-home card

Camp stretch: Run Stage 2 (the cipher) and the Rap.

05 Session 3: Scam Spotters

Goal: Kids use SPOT to find the clues in a fishy message and know that PAUSE AND ASK is always a safe answer.

Crew: Peeper, Gifty (adult voice).

Supplies: Set B cards (24), a Pond drawn on the board with 12 circles (Quick Catch) or 30 (Full Pond), crayons, the SPOT sign.

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
5	Warm-up: Parcel Pal (Concepts Lab Demo 03, "Try This Now")
20	Main game: Pond Patrol (Spot the Fishy)
8	Role-play: Check a Different Way (R6)
4	Calm-down
5	Close

LEADER SCRIPT

Warm-up. Read this fictional text aloud: "Parcel Pal: your package could not be delivered. Pay a 1.99 redelivery fee: parcelpal-fee.test/pay." SAY: "In 20 seconds, find the pressure, the link and the ask. You do not need to say 'it looks fake'. Look at what it asks you to do."

Teach SPOT. SAY: "Secrets, Pressure, Offers too good to be true, Tricks to move you, like a link or a request for a password. Spot them and Peeper says 'Nice noticing!'"

Main game: Pond Patrol.

1. Teams of 3 to 5. Each team shows one of three answers on "Peek!": FISHY (neck brush), REAL (star hands), PAUSE AND ASK (Pause Palm).
2. Read a card from Set B twice. Teams whisper-think 10 seconds. Say "Peek!"
3. Read the back. Say "Nice noticing!" to every team.
4. **Fill the Pond.** Every card adds 1 circle. If at least half the teams picked the best answer, add 1 more. For each new SPOT clue a team names (up to 2 per card), add 1 more.
5. **Hackles move:** the whole class does Hackles Up, Pause Palm, Check, Tell Wave.
6. **Pause needs a Check.** A team that shows PAUSE AND ASK on a clearly fishy or real card scores the bonus circle only by saying how it would check.

7. Quick Catch is 8 cards (B1, B3, B8, B10, B13, B17, B20, B23), Pond of 12. Full Pond is 24 cards in three rounds (Notice, Name, Move), Pond of 30. **The class cannot lose:** if the Pond is short at the end, Peeper's Boost fills the rest.

Nobody is out. A Pass card is always fine.

Role-play: Check a Different Way (R6, Games Pack file 06). Triads: Teller, Friend, Observer. Message card: "A text from a number you do not know says: 'Hi! It's me, your friend! Click this link to see a funny video!'"

- **Teller:** "Hackles up. I don't know this number. I'll check a different way. I'll ask my friend in person, not use the link. Then I'll tell my dad."

Swap roles. Ask the Observer: "Did the Teller name 'a different way'?"

Calm-down. Warm Breath, or a one-minute doodle.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 4
Hackles Club: Scam Spotters. Today your child practiced spotting SPOT clues: Secrets, Pressure, Offers too good to be true, Tricks like a link or a login ask. Try at home: Read one pretend scam message aloud together (a "You won a free pony" message) and find the SPOT clues. Then decide how you would check it a different way.	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child gets stuck on "https means it is safe".** Say, "The lock only means the connection is private, not that the site is honest. We still check who it is from and what it wants." [VERIFY wording with your counselor or IT contact.]
- **A child says "my grandma fell for that".** "It is never anyone's fault. People who trick are very good at it. Thank you for telling me."
- **Every team picks PAUSE AND ASK.** Ask, "What would you check?" Accept one answer each.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
12	Read-Aloud 5: "The Treasure That Wasn't" (Games Pack, file 04)
5	Talk: "Which SPOT clues did you hear?"
7	Quick Catch with 4 cards
3	Warm Breath, take-home card

Camp stretch: Run Round 3 "Move": one team acts out the right next step (Pause and Tell). Teams never act out the sneaky part.

06 Session 4: Data Detective

Goal: Kids see that small pieces of information add up, and can sort what is fun to share from what stays private.

Crew: Pip.

Supplies: A pretend person card ("Quinn"), index cards, an envelope, a postcard-sized paper, two plates or papers labeled SHARE and SHELL.

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
7	Warm-up: Postcard or Envelope? (Concepts Lab Demo 05)
18	Main game: Meet Quinn (mosaic game)
10	Share or Shell sort and "Ask before you post"
3	Calm-down
5	Close

LEADER SCRIPT

Warm-up: Postcard or Envelope? Write a teacher-made note that says only "hello". Fold it and pass it along a row. Who could have read it? Seal an identical note in an envelope and pass that. Who can read it now? What is still visible on the outside? (Never use notes the children wrote.) SAY: "Information travels in pieces. What is on the outside of a message can be seen by many hands."

Main game: Meet Quinn. Quinn is made up. Quinn plays soccer, goes to Maple Middle School, and has a dog named Biscuit. Give each team four index cards, one fact per card: soccer, school name, dog's name, Quinn's neighborhood bakery. SAY: "Pick two facts. Does the pair tell a stranger more than either fact alone?" Teams share. SAY: "Pieces add up like a mosaic. A single tile is nothing. Together they form a picture. Pip decides what to share." (This is the mosaic effect, from Concepts Lab Demo 09. Use fictional people only. Never look up a real person.)

Share or Shell sort. Teams sort cards onto SHARE and SHELL plates: a drawing I made, my favorite color, my home address, my password, my school's name, my smile, my phone number, my favorite song. Discuss one tricky card ("my school's name": ask a grown-up).

Ask before you post. SAY: "Before sharing a photo that has other people in it, ask them." Pairs practice: "Is it okay if I share this photo?" "Yes" or "No thanks."

Calm-down. Shell breaths: curl small, breathe in for 4, out for 6.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 5
Hackles Club: Data Detective. Today we met Quinn, a made-up kid, and learned that small facts add up to a picture. Try at home: Pick any three facts about a made-up person and decide which two a stranger should not be able to put together. Then ask your child: "What would Pip keep in the shell?"	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child gives their real school or street.** Say, "Pip says that one goes in the shell." Laugh gently. Do not repeat it.
- **A child says their family shares a lot.** "Grown-ups decide many things. You can always ask, 'Do I say OK?'"
- **The discussion drifts to a stranger who contacted a child online.** Use the Start Here Section 7 script. Do not go further.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
12	Read-Aloud 3: "Pip Picks a Shell" (Games Pack, file 04; written for ages 5 to 7, fine for 8 to 9 with a silly voice)
5	Talk
7	Quinn mosaic game with 4 cards
3	Warm Breath, take-home card

Camp stretch: Each team draws a Quinn poster with "Quinn shares" and "Quinn keeps in the shell".

07 Session 5: Kind Clicks and Upstander Moves

Goal: Kids can pick one of four safe ways to respond when someone is unkind online, and know that Tell It is always okay.

Crew: Ember.

Supplies: Four corner signs: **Say It, Stand With, Keep It, Tell It**. Scenario cards (below). A calm corner with cushions, if you have one.

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
5	Warm-up: Kind or Unkind thumbs
20	Main game: Four Moves corners
10	Role-play: Keep It (R16)
4	Screen-break moment (Ember)
4	Close

LEADER SCRIPT

Warm-up. Read kind and unkind sentences. Thumbs up for kind, Pause Palm for unkind. Examples: "Nice goal!" "Everyone knows you can't draw." "Want to join our team?" Say: "Kind clicks are warm. Unkind clicks hurt."

The four moves. SAY: "Bystanders are the people who see it. Upstanders are the people who do something safe. There are four safe moves, and any one helps."

- **Say It:** "That's not cool. Please stop."
- **Stand With:** go to the person and say, "Are you okay? I'm here."
- **Keep It:** do not forward it or pass it on. "I'm not passing it on."
- **Tell It:** tell a trusted adult. Always okay.

Main game: Four Moves corners. Put a sign in each corner. Read a scenario. Kids walk silently to the corner of the move they would pick first. One child per corner says why. Rule: **there is no single right answer, and Tell It is always fine.** Scenario cards (all invented):

1. In the class game chat, someone posts a mean joke about a classmate.
2. A friend forwards you a mean picture of a classmate and says, "Send it on!"
3. A kid at a club has a rumor spread about them in a group chat.
4. Someone you know is left out of a group game on purpose.
5. A classmate says, "I didn't know how to say anything."

Use 4 scenarios. Never use a real child's name or a real incident.

Role-play: Keep It (R16, Games Pack file 06). Triads: Teller, Friend, Observer. Message card: "A friend forwards you a mean meme about a classmate and says, 'Send it on!'"

- **Teller:** "I'm not going to send it. It could hurt them."
- **Friend (voiced by the Observer's card):** "It's just a meme."
- **Teller:** "I'll keep it. I'm not passing it on. I'll tell a trusted adult if it keeps going."

Swap. Observer checks: "Did the Teller stay calm?"

Screen-break moment (Ember). SAY: "Ember says: your eyes, your neck and your brain need a break from screens. Stand up, roll your shoulders, look at something far away for 20 seconds, take a Warm Breath." Do it.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 6
Hackles Club: Kind Clicks and Upstander Moves. Today your child learned four safe ways to respond when someone is unkind: Say It, Stand With, Keep It, Tell It. Try at home: Ask, "Which move would you pick first?" Whatever they say, thank them. Then plan one screen-free break this week.	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child tells a story about being picked on.** Say, "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Nobody deserves that." Use the Start Here card. Tell your safeguarding lead the same day.
- **A child jokes about a classmate.** Pause. "Kind clicks, please. Try again." Do not shame.
- **A child describes something sexual, a threat, or a person who scared them.** Stop the game. Use the Start Here Section 6 card and Section 7 script. Tell your safeguarding lead the same day.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
10	A short play: Role-play R16 acted by the librarian and a puppet (Games Pack, file 06)
5	Talk: "Which move would you pick?"
7	Four Moves corners with 2 scenarios
3	Warm Breath and take-home card
2	Goodbye

Camp stretch: Add Role-play R20 "Saying No Kindly" ("Nope. My passphrase is just for me. If you want to team up, let's play together.").

08 Session 6: Oops Recovery, Family Code Word and a Quick Door (the Club finale)

Goal: Kids know the O.O.P.S. steps, can say "I made an oops", set up a family code word idea, and finish a Quick Door mission as a team.

Crew: Fixit, Rinse, Peeper, Gifty.

Supplies: O.O.P.S. card, the Fake Giveaway post, four link cards, envelopes, a "Door" taped on the floor, certificates (file 13).

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
10	O.O.P.S. practice (Fixit and Rinse)
8	Family Code Word (R19)
20	Main game: Quick Door (Mission E2, Stages 1 and 2)
4	Calm-down
5	Certificates and close

LEADER SCRIPT

O.O.P.S. SAY: "Fixit says: everybody makes an oops, even grown-ups. When it happens: **Okay**, breathe. **Off**, close it or turn off the screen. **People**, tell someone you trust. **Secure** it, change the password with an adult's help." Rinse adds: "Rinse asks three calm questions: What happened? Are we safe? What do we do next?" Pairs practice: "I made an oops, and I need help." The partner says the Good Grown-up Reply.

Family Code Word (R19). SAY: "Scammers can pretend to be someone you love. A family code word is a secret word only your family knows. If a call or message claims to be a family member in trouble, you ask for the word. If they can't say it, you don't act." Role-play: Teller (child), Family Member (reads a pretend word from the card: "pickle"), Observer.

- **Teller:** "Hackles up. That's urgent and secret. I will hang up."
- **Teller:** "I'll call my uncle back on the number I already know. What's our code word?"
- **Family Member:** "It's pickle." (the pretend word on the card)
- **Teller:** "If he can't say it, it's not him. I'll tell you."

SAY: "Hang up. Look up. Call back. That is the whole plan." (Concepts Lab Demo 08.) **Real families pick their own word, never say it in public, and never type it in a chat. The word on the card is only an example. Do not ask the children for their word.**

Main game: Quick Door (Mission E2, The Case of the Fake Giveaway). SAY: "The Pixel Pals game (pretend) posted a giveaway! Priya's hackles are up. We must prove whether it is real. The Quiet Door opens when the case is solved."

- **Stage 1, SPOT the Post.** Read: "PIXEL PALS GIVEAWAY!!! You have been chosen to win 10,000 FREE coins! Only 5 minutes left! Click this link and log in to claim: [pixelpals-rewards.example](#). Don't tell your parents, they might ruin the surprise!" Teams underline the SPOT clues and write the four letters in the order the clues appear from the top. Answer: **OPTS** (O: free coins, P: only 5 minutes, T: click and log in, S: don't tell your parents).
- **Stage 2, Link Lineup.** Four links, read aloud as "pixel-pals" and "pixe-one-pals": 1) [pixelpals.example/help](#) 2) [pixe1pals.example/prize](#) 3) [pixelpals-FREE-coins.example](#) 4) [pixelpals.example/news](#). The real site name is the part right before .example. Which two are fishy? Answer: **2 and 3.**
- **The Door ritual.** The whole group stands in a circle at the taped Door. Hackles up (neck brush). Pause (one slow breath, palm up). Check (eyes). Tell (hand on heart, reach out). Teams whisper the Door Phrase, "Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell." The Door Keeper says, "The Quiet Door is open. Thank you for being calm."

Calm-down. Warm Breath. Tell Wave.

Certificates. Say each child's first name. Hand out the Club certificate and, if you use them, Passport stamps or Hackles Patch pages.

TAKE-HOME FAMILY CARD

FIELD NOTE	No. 7
Hackles Club: Oops, Code Words and the Quiet Door. Today your child learned the O.O.P.S. steps and what a family code word is. Try at home (10 minutes): Choose a family code word together. Make it a silly pair of random words. Keep it private: do not post it, text it or write it on a shared device. Add a callback rule: even with the word, hang up and call back on a number you already know. A false alarm is welcome. It is never your child's fault.	

IF IT GOES WRONG

- **A child shares their real family code word.** Say, "That one sounds real. Let's change it at home tonight." Do not repeat it.
- **A child says "we don't have a family code".** "Plenty of families do not. Your trusted adults can make one. Use the take-home card."

- **A child is upset by the idea of a scammer calling.** "Scammers are people far away who are very good at tricking. We practice so you stay calm." Swap to the Door game.

STORY-TIME VERSION (LIBRARY, 30 MINUTES)

MIN	WHAT
3	Welcome, chant
12	Read-Aloud 8: "Sam's Whoops Day" (Games Pack, file 04)
5	Talk: "What did Sam do after the oops?"
5	O.O.P.S. rhyme and the Tell practice
3	Warm Breath
2	Certificates (library stamps)

09 Camp Session 7: The Quiet Door Escape (camp only)

Goal: Teams solve a four-stage defense-only mission and open the Door together.

Supplies: All of Mission E2 (the Fake Giveaway): giveaway post, four link cards, four routine cards (Pause, Hackles up!, Tell a trusted adult, Check a different way) with letters on the back, a Tell script card, five envelopes, Gifty (a gold gift box).

MIN	WHAT
5	Gather, promises, chant
35	Full mission: Stages 1 to 4
5	Door ritual and debrief
5	Close

Stage 3, Hackles Order. Shuffle four cards. Teams put them in the right order: Hackles up! (S), Pause (A), Check a different way (F), Tell a trusted adult (E). The backs spell **SAFE**.

Stage 4, Priya Tells. The team practices the Tell script with the Door Keeper acting as the trusted adult: "I need help with something online. I found a post that says I won coins, but it says to keep it a secret and to log in. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something." The Door Keeper gives the Good Grown-up Reply. The team gets the Hackles Key.

Debrief (3 minutes). Which flag did you find first? Why are secrets a flag? What if you already clicked? (Tell. It is never your fault.) Name your trusted adults.

Hints (the same for every stage). Hint 1: a nudge. Hint 2: a bigger nudge. Hint 3: the Door Keeper does the first step with the team. A team never loses.

If it goes wrong. If time runs short, run Stages 1 and 2 only, plus the Door ritual.

10 **Camp Session 8: Hackles Day, Kids Run the Stations (camp only)**

Goal: Kids teach families the Hackles routine, play together, and finish with the pledge.

Format: 60 minutes, families invited. Follow the Family Night Kit (file 05) for stations and flow. Children lead; adults help.

MIN	WHAT
10	Welcome and the Hackles Chant, led by the kids
30	Four stations (kids host): Spot the Fishy, Passphrase Vault, Help Ladder Climb, Share or Shell
10	Family Code Word table (families make a code word idea together; nothing is collected)
5	Pledge and certificates
5	Goodbye

Rules. No photos unless your host organisation's permission covers them. No child is required to host. Hosts hold a script card and may pass it. Adults never put children on stage alone.

If it goes wrong. If a family shares a real worry, thank them, give the page "What to do if your child tells you something scary" from the Family Engagement Pack (kit/06_Family/), and tell your safeguarding lead.

11 Quick reference for leaders

- **Shape:** Gather 5, Warm-up 5, Main game 15 to 20, Talk 8 to 10, Calm-down 4, Close 5.
- **SPOT:** Secrets, Pressure, Offers too good to be true, Tricks.
- **Help Ladder:** a friend you trust, a trusted adult, a report tool. Next-Rung Rule.
- **Tell sentence:** "I need help with something online. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."
- **Good Grown-up Reply:** "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."
- **No elimination. No losing. Pass is always fine.**
- **If a child tells you something:** Start Here, Section 6.